



Sony makes fans await GT5

For the second time Sony has delayed the launch of Gran Turismo 5 in view of launching the much awaited Move motion controlled games

Icons of Trust

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ston, but 71 per cent of Transcend users remain loyal to their chosen brand – a mixed bag.

- 8) Market awareness for Transcend is higher. Interestingly SanDisk also enjoys a good reputation – probably because of their good reputation in the photography circles.

The most trusted

Our first tie! Kingston and Transcend cannot outdo the other, and SanDisk follows closely. HP occupies the third/fourth place depending on whether you count our winners collectively or not. This is surprising, for we haven't seen much flash products from them, but a strong brand name can overcome the worst of situations and this is a pristine example of this adage at work.

WIRELESS NETWORKING

Thanks to the Internet revolution, Wi-Fi routers have become more commonplace these days. Wi-Fi routers are gaining popularity mainly because they're the easiest way to share an Internet connection. With the way broadband has penetrated the bigger cities, the inevitable push for a convenient, wire-free means to share a high bandwidth line, surely couldn't be far behind. From humble routers supporting 802.11/g to the latest ones supporting 802.11/n and a host of other features geared towards better performance and signal coverage there are a slew of models available. Up to three years back, only enterprises looked for wireless solutions, now walk into any computer hardware shop, and there's a good chances you'll come across a couple of options. There are a number of brands too, and with this segment heating up, we had to do a market check.

Market Watch

802.11n is the latest specification and routers based on this standard have become affordable enough for you to consider them. Some brands are trying to break away from the boredom of wireless specifications and standards and simply segregate products on the basis of usage patterns, using related terms like "value", "performance", "home", "enthusiast" and so on. We applaud this move, but at times it's better to know a bit

about the specifications than relative terms.

Wireless networking is also getting a shot in the arm, courtesy of an unexpected quarter – HDTVs. Many such displays come advertising features like wireless browsing, and such, and while they require a PC to work with (after all how do you configure your router?) you can essentially browse using your wireless connection. Such TVs are wireless ready, and require a small dongle to work with.

Perceptions from our survey

- 1) D-Link is generally synonymous with wireless products. Ask anyone to name a brand dealing in these products, and chances are nearly 50 per cent of them will say D-Link. We feel this is due to them being in the market longer than other brands. In addition to this, D-Link does quite a bit of advertising through various media.
- 2) When it comes to brand and quality trust, it's D-Link all the way. Linksys trails by around 19 per cent, while Netgear is 36 per cent behind. Belkin occupies fourth position. While the other three are fairly old players, Belkin is newer, and has been doing business here for around four years, no more. Interestingly, quite a few people have heard of ASUS, a brand that made wireless routers, but are much more fabled for their

motherboards and graphic cards.

- 3) If you've heard of it more than anything else, chances are you'll trust it in terms of reliability. D-Link wins here, with a small margin between Linksys and Netgear, who are number two and three respectively.
- 4) D-Link is also perceived to be the most technologically advanced brand. We feel this has less to do with actual fact, and more to do with popularity.
- 5) Apple's strong reputation holds them in good stead. Despite having the tiniest product portfolio in the business, their routers enjoy a good reputation. In fact they out pace some heavyweights such as Belkin, Zyxel, Senao and SMC in this regard. The leaders remain D-Link, Linksys and Netgear (in that order)
- 6) Many people recommend D-Link to others, but Linksys trails closely in this regard. We feel Linksys' recent marketing campaign for their routers seems to have helped their position. Belkin has also done a lot of promotion, but we see them languishing at the bottom. Evidently, the brand still needs to penetrate the market better.

The most trusted

D-Link maintained a lead on all five parameters, thereby taking top spot. Linksys is a very close second, while Netgear an equidistant third. 

